



Safe to use hands-free devices in cars

Drivers who use hands-free electronic devices, as opposed to handheld ones, are less likely to get into a crash. <https://digit.in/mar19-28>



Amazon entering WiFi router space

According to a latest press release, Amazon is acquiring the home mesh wi-fi router company Eero. <https://digit.in/mar19-29>



WARHAMMER: HOBBY ART

Warhammer is one of the richest fictional universes around, with over 50 series of books, with each series having multiple novels. All these series provide backstories for the main activity of war gaming, using figurines sold by Games Workshop. These figurines are without colour, and one of the important activities of the Warhammer fandom, is to apply paint on the figurines. These paintjobs can be very elaborate, and involves slowly and carefully bringing out the details using multiple coats. There is plenty of room for self expression, and each completed figurine is unique to that individual. The community shares and critiques the completed jobs.

HARRY POTTER: FAN FICTION

The Harry Potter fan community, which calls themselves Potterheads, really excels at writing fan fiction. The activity started in the early days of the franchise, with fans writing book length fanfiction even before the author officially released the titles. These works were so popular, that they even circulated on torrent sites. The fiction is typically set in the future of the main books, or in the past. Potterheads have a penchant for exploring romantic link ups through these fan works, which are not canonical in the originals series. One particular pairing which is popular is called Dramione, and involves Draco and Hermione.



Credit: Lisa Herrera

STAR TREK: KLINGON KARAOKE

Trekkies, or fans of the Star Trek series engage in an activity known as Klingon Karaoke, that combines multiple fan activities into one. First, the trekkies cosplay as an existing or made up character from the Star Trek universe. Then, they learn the fictional language of Klingon, and translate songs into that language. Finally, they meet up and form circles to sing the songs in Klingon, using the same music as the original. The fans bring their own music CDs to conventions for this purpose. The activity is known as filking, which is folk music based on science fiction. Klingon Karaoke can be witnessed live in some Star Trek conventions.

THE X-FILES: SHIPPING

The whole idea of promoting a romantic link between two characters emerged from the fandom around The X-Files in the early days of the internet. The fans coined the word "relationshipers" to denote those who wanted the leads of the series, Fox Mulder and Dana Scully to become a couple, not in fan fiction, but officially on the TV show. Anyone who did not want the pairing was referred to as a "noromo", which is a short form of "no romance". The noromos went to such an extreme, that they actually wanted the lead characters to hate each other. The word eventually shortened to "shippers", and the activity spread to other fandoms.

